



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
Policy on the Management of Accelerated Promotion

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THE ACCELERATED PROMOTION PROGRAMME

1. Background/Introduction

Historically, accelerated promotion programmes have served various purposes in police services and other business environments. For all organizations, these programmes have generally contributed to their capacity to manage their manpower talent, motivate younger members to excel as well as to bring new knowledge and skills into the management group. All such programmes have generally been futuristic and based on the premise of providing a pool of middle managers with extensive knowledge of the functions, operations and values of the organization, in the short to medium term.

The Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) is no exception. For over 40 years it has used accelerated promotion programmes to augment the officer corps, fill manpower gaps and provided alternative pathways for the advancement of members and by extension, the organization. Without question, accelerated promotion programmes have not only bolstered the infusion of new knowledge, skills and ways of thinking in the officer corps. Importantly, these programmes have assisted in cushioning the impact of the high rate of attrition that has adversely affected the organization.

This accelerated promotion programme is in keeping with the Jamaica Constabulary Force's Selection for Promotion Procedure, and represents one of the several pathways for promotion within the organization. The programme is designed to identify, select and train suitably qualified constables, corporals and sergeants to become members of the officer corps. This document provides the framework for managing the initial application and selection processes as well as training and development of the participants.

2. Programme Design

The Accelerated Promotion Programme will include a training and development component which is intended to ensure that participants:

- a) are engaged in a structured programme of learning and guided development;
- b) strengthen their competencies as police managers and leaders;
- c) are given opportunities to bridge experiential gaps in general policing and to positively influence and impact the management and culture of policing; and
- d) add value to the organization while being engaged in the training programme.

Training and Development comprise the following seven stages:

Stage 1 – Personal Effectiveness and Police Supervisory Studies

This preliminary stage will be specifically designed to provide professional and practical training to prepare candidates to manage a station. This will allow participants to develop the requisite skills needed for station management and police professional development. Each participant will complete a Professional

Development Plan and be assigned a coach and mentor.

Stage 2 – Station Management Attachment

The station management attachment will provide the participants with experience in supervision, station management and practical policing operations. Based on performance in this stage, participants will progress to Stage 3.

Stage 3 – Academic Module

Participants will undergo a period of academic training at the National Police College of Jamaica.

Stage 4 – Special Command Course

This stage of the training will specifically provide professional and practical training to prepare candidates to operate across a wider span of control at the divisional level.

Stage 5 – Station Command Attachment

Upon promotion to the rank of Inspector, participants will be assigned station command.

Stage 6 – Command Course

This period of classroom training will encompass elements of Command and Operations Field Commander Training to support the participants' professional development and knowledge on how an effective organization functions. The expertise of experienced external managers and executives will be used to deliver best practices in organizational leadership management and transformation. Candidates that complete this stage satisfactorily will proceed to the divisional attachment stage of the programme.

Stage 7 – Divisional Assignments with Workshops and Seminars

Participants will rotate through administrative, operational, investigative and community safety roles within the assigned divisions. This stage will provide the participants with wider operational and development experience in their role as managers.

In order to enable effective management of their performance, participants will be assessed at all stages of the programme. This will provide the opportunity for coaching and guidance of the individual and enhance decision-making throughout the duration of the programme. At the minimum, Assessment Reports should be completed by the Course Administrative Team as follows:

- a) *Classroom Training* – interim at 6 weeks, three months intervals and at the end of each stage.
- b) *Attachment Stages* – Quarterly and at the completion of each attachment by the reporting manager assigned and through scheduled and unscheduled visits.
- c) *Programme Completion* – prepare a final report at the completion of the programme.
- d) The recommendations for promotion of participants will be initiated. The Police Service Commission will be responsible for promotions/ appointments when satisfied that the participants have satisfied the requirements and are suitable.

3. Terms and Conditions

The following outlines the terms and conditions of the programme:

- a) This programme is applicable to members from the rank of constable to sergeant.
- b) Members must personally apply for consideration to join the programme.
- c) Progression and promotion will be dependent on successful completion of each phase of the selection process and each stage of training.
- d) Members entering at the rank of constable and corporal will be promoted to the rank of sergeant upon commencement of the training.
- e) Participants will be recommended for promotion to the rank of inspector after achieving the requisite competence and successful completion of Stage 2 (Station Attachment).
- f) Participants who have attained the rank of inspector whose Performance Management Appraisal ratings are very good will be recommended for promotion to the rank of Assistant Superintendent after successfully completing Stage 5 (Station Command).
- g) Participants shall be assessed periodically and reported on as to their suitability to remain on the programme.
- h) The programme will operate using the hurdle system. Participants will be allowed one re-sit per examination/assessment but will receive only the passing grade.
- i) Failure or lack of successful completion of any phase of the selection process or any stage of training will result in the automatic termination of participation in the programme. In circumstance where participant are required to terminate the programme before its conclusion, he/she will retain the rank at which he/she exited the programme. Eligibility for further promotions thereafter shall be in accordance with the policy treating on promotions in the JCF.
- j) Conviction for breaches of discipline during the course of the programme may be considered cause for separation from the programme.

- k) Absences from the course of training must be kept at a minimum. Absences for more than ten consecutive days may be cause for separation from the programme.
- l) All other terms and conditions as required by law and the rules and regulations of the JCF are applicable to this programme.

4. The Course Administrative Team

The Administrative Team will be responsible for overseeing the course including monitoring the effectiveness of training, providing leadership oversight to the planning, implementation, facilitation, tracking day-to-day operations and assessment of the participants and programme. The team will consist of a coordinator assisted by syndicate directors who will manage the training and development process.

The Coordinator will report to the Administrative Director of the Faculty of Leadership and Professional Development. The Administrative Team will recommend at the appropriate juncture, those participants who have successfully completed the requisite stages and are suitable for promotion.

5. Application Process

The recruitment of candidates will be based on the organization's need. It will commence with a notification for applications to the programme along with eligibility criteria which will be published in the Force Orders. Applications will be opened to members at the rank of constable to sergeant. Application must be accompanied by:

- a) a résumé;
- b) evidence of compliance with the Corruption Prevention Act (receipts or letter from the Integrity Commission); and
- c) proof of qualifications.

Completed application form (Appendix A) must be submitted to the Commanding Officer which will then be forwarded to the Assistant Commissioner, Administration Branch.

6. The Selection Process

The selection process will comprise of eight phases; i) Written Examination, ii) Physical Test, iii). Integrity Screening, iv) Assessment Centre, v) Panel Interview, vi) Medical Examination, vii) Psychometric Test, and viii) Final Selection. Successful candidates will be required to pass all phases.

Phase I - Written Examination – this will be in accordance with the syllabus as published in Force Orders

Phase II - Physical Test - this will comprise a physical endurance test in which

successful candidates must attain a minimum score of 70%.

Phase III - Integrity Screening - this will include intelligence vetting by Major Organize Crime Agency (MOCA) and the National Intelligent Bureau (NIB), and polygraph testing.

Phase IV- Assessment Centre - this may be written, oral or blended, and will assess the candidates in the areas of; i) critical thinking, ii) problem solving, iii) systematic reasoning, iv) communication, v) leadership, and vi) team skills.

Phase V - Panel Interview - candidates who are successful in Phase IV will be interviewed by a panel appointed by the Commissioner of Police. At a minimum, the interview will assess each candidate in the following areas; i) leadership, ii) team skills, iii) verbal communication skills, iv) situational judgment, v) flexibility, and vi) initiative and accountability.

Phase VI- Medical Tests - this will comprise drug screening and a medical examination. Candidates will be required to submit the results of an executive profile to the Medical Services Branch.

Phase VII- Psychometric Tests – this will include an examination of candidates’ intelligence, abilities, potential and personality as part of the assessment process.

Phase VIII-Final Selection - the Deputy Commissioner, Administration & Support Services Portfolio, will convene the final selection panel. This panel will shortlist applicants and make recommendations to the Commissioner of Police on the candidates who are adjudged suitable for the training programme. This panel will be constituted as follows:

- a) DCP Administration & Support Services Portfolio;
- b) JCF Staff Officer;
- c) ACP Training Branch; and
- d) a Senior Human Resource practitioner who specializes in talent management.

7. Discipline

The following disciplinary matters may render a member ineligible for admission:

Orderly Room Matters

- a) Members with three or more Orderly Room convictions will not be allowed to participate in the Selection Procedure until two years following the date of the last conviction.
- b) Where a matter is pending, a decision will be made following a review by the Assistant Commissioner, Administration Branch.

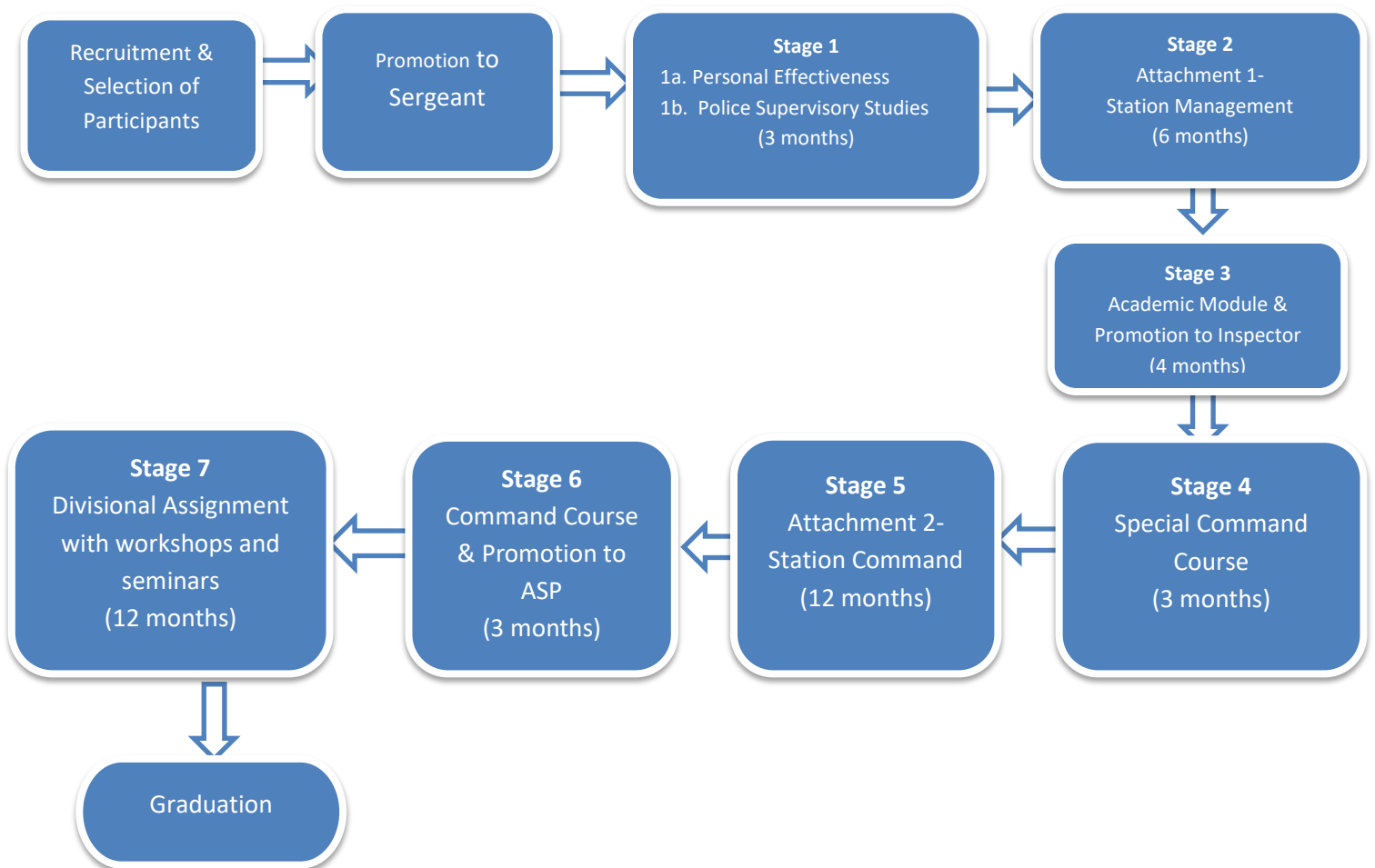
Court of Enquiry

- a) Where an applicant has a Court of Enquiry matter that is pending, outstanding or a conviction which is being appealed, his/her application will not be approved.
- b) Where an applicant was convicted at a Court of Enquiry within three years prior to the commencement of the written stage, he/she will not be permitted to participate.

Criminal Matters

- a) Where a member is criminally charged, the member's application to participate will not be approved.
- b) Where any criminal investigation has been completed and the matter is awaiting the ruling of the Director of Public Prosecution, the member involved will not be allowed to participate.
- c) Members on interdiction/suspension arising from criminal charges will not be permitted to participate.

Figure 1 – Accelerated Promotion Program Flow Chart



Appendix A:**APPLICATION TO PARTICIPATE IN THE
ACCELERATED PROMOTION PROGRAMME**

Instruction: Complete all sections accurately. Print response clearly in black or blue ink.

SECTION I

BIO DATA		
Name, Rank & Reg #: _____ (Please print in Capital Letters)		Date of Birth: ____/____/____ DD MM YY
Marital Status:	☐ ☐ ☐	Number of dependents: ____
Certified copies of proof of qualification to be appended	SECONDARY LEVEL EDUCATION (CXC, CSEC, CAPE)	TERTIARY LEVEL EDUCATION
Particulars of Service		
	Particulars	Date
Special Skills		
Signature of Applicant: _____ Rank & Reg #: _____ JCF Email: _____ Date: ____/____/____ Telephone No. _____ DD MM YY		

SECTION II

TO BE COMPLETED BY COMMANDING OFFICER		
Sick Leave		
No. of days taken in the past 3 years: Year 1: _____ Year 2: _____ Year 3: _____	Date of Last sick leave: ____/____/____ DD MM YY	Number of sick leave due to injury on duty: _____
s	Disciplinary Breaches	
Number of entries in the last 2 years: _____	Number of reports and type pending: _____	Date of last report: ____/____/____ DD MM YY
PMAS ASSESSMENT FOR THE PAST YEAR MUST ACCOMPANY APPLICATION		

